ENGLISH C1 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Nominalisation

Nominalisation can make reasoning compact and cohesive, but excessive noun-heavy writing hides agency and weakens the verbs that carry a sentence forward.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Package a process as a noun while preserving meaning, agency and logical relationships.

Turn processes and qualities into noun phrases to condense information, connect arguments and shift focus in formal texts.

MODEL

The committee rejected the plan. -> The committee's rejection of the plan...

verb/adjective -> noun phrase + precise support

6 GUIDED STAGES · 29 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Form accurate noun phrases from verbs and adjectives.

OUTCOME 2

02

Use nominalisation to package known information and build cohesion.

OUTCOME 3

03

Decide when a direct verb is clearer than a dense noun phrase.

Build meaning before form

Turn processes and qualities into noun phrases to condense information, connect arguments and shift focus in formal texts.

What nominalisation changes

The committee rejected the proposal presents an action. The committee's rejection of the proposal packages that action as a thing that can become the subject, object or reference point of another sentence.

This grammatical shift changes information flow, not merely vocabulary.

Cohesion through information packaging

A previous proposition can be compressed into a noun phrase: The service expanded rapidly. This expansion created new roles. The noun phrase points backwards and opens space for the next claim.

Effective academic writing alternates between processes expressed as verbs and concepts expressed as nouns.

Clause	Packaged reference
The system failed.	the system's failure
Access improved.	the improvement in access
The policy was effective.	the effectiveness of the policy

Agency and responsibility

The destruction of the records removes the actor unless a by-phrase or possessive restores it. When accountability matters, name the agent: the contractor's destruction of the records.

Impersonal style is a rhetorical choice, not an automatic sign of formality.

Control density with strong verbs

A sentence such as The implementation of the evaluation of the provision is difficult to process because nouns bury every action. Recasting one or two nouns as verbs restores movement and clarity.

Use nominalisation to organise an argument, not to decorate it.

02 · VISUAL MAP

Reason through the pattern

The visual turns an action into a labelled package that can be moved through a paragraph. A second checkpoint asks whether the agent and main verb remain visible.

01	02	03
verb/adjective	noun phrase	precise support

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the process or quality you want to treat as a concept.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Choose the correct noun form and its preposition or complement.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Decide whether the agent should remain visible.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read for density: restore a verb if the sentence becomes abstract or unclear.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Source	Nominalisation	Example
decide	decision	the committee's decision
expand	expansion	the expansion of the service
available	availability	the availability of data

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

the system failed	the system's failure
access improved	the improvement in access
the policy was effective	the policy's effectiveness

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Using the wrong derived noun or preposition.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Removing the agent when responsibility matters.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Stacking several abstract nouns without a clear main verb.

Recognition in context

Choose the form that completes each situation naturally.

A1 · CONTEXT 1

The committee's ___ to postpone surprised everyone.

OPTIONS decision · deciding · decisiveness to · decide

A2 · CONTEXT 2

A detailed ___ of the results was published.

OPTIONS analysis · analyse · analysation · analysing of

A3 · CONTEXT 3

The ___ of funding remains uncertain.

OPTIONS availability · available · availableness · avail

A4 · CONTEXT 4

Their ___ to report the error caused delays.

OPTIONS failure · failing of · fail · failed

A5 · CONTEXT 5

The ___ of the policy took six months.

OPTIONS implementation · implement · implementingness · implemented

A6 · CONTEXT 6

The investigation ___ the regulator began yesterday.

OPTIONS by · of · to · for doing

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

02 · PRACTICE STAGE

Two connected decisions

Resolve two connected choices within the same context.

B1 · CONNECTED CONTEXT 1

The _____ of the data by the team led to the _____ of a new pattern.

OPTIONS Gap 1: analysis / analyse / analysingness · Gap 2: identification / identify / identity

B2 · CONNECTED CONTEXT 2

The _____ to extend the deadline followed the client's _____ of the first proposal.

OPTIONS Gap 1: decision / decide / deciding of · Gap 2: rejection / reject / rejectingness

B3 · CONNECTED CONTEXT 3

A rapid _____ in demand forced the _____ of production.

OPTIONS Gap 1: increase / increasingly / increased · Gap 2: expansion / expand / expansive

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided text

Maintain the target structure throughout a complete text.

C1 · GUIDED APPLICATION

The board’s _____ to enter the market followed a careful _____ of demand. The _____ of local partners reduced risk, while the _____ of a clear timetable created uncertainty. Final _____ of the plan is expected in June.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

absence · absent · absentee · analyse · analysis · analytical · approval · approve · approving · avail · availability · available · decide · decidingness · decision

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open text

Supply every form without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT APPLICATION

The team decided to delay. -> The team's _____. The regulator investigated the incident. -> The _____ by the regulator. Funds were not available. -> The _____. The supplier failed to deliver. -> The supplier's _____. Users responded positively. -> The positive _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled production

Transform the idea without changing its meaning.

E1 · CONTROLLED TASK 1

Nominalise: The company expanded rapidly.

_____
_____

E2 · CONTROLLED TASK 2

Write an original Nominalisation response for context 2. Include approval of the plan by the agency.

_____
_____

E3 · CONTROLLED TASK 3

Write an original Nominalisation response for context 3. Include revised, implemented.

_____
_____

E4 · CONTROLLED TASK 4

Correct: the analyse of the data.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative mission

Use the structure in original responses and realistic situations.

F1 · COMMUNICATION TASK 1

Write an original Nominalisation response for context 1. Include expansion, expanded.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · COMMUNICATION TASK 2

Write an original Nominalisation response for context 2. Include by the supplier.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · COMMUNICATION TASK 3

Write an original Nominalisation response for context 3. Include evaluated, completed.

_____
_____
_____

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: noun form.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: preposition.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: agency.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: density.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

decision

Use “decision”. Identify the process or quality you want to treat as a concept.

A2

analysis

Use “analysis”. Choose the correct noun form and its preposition or complement.

A3

availability

Use “availability”. Decide whether the agent should remain visible.

A4

failure

Use “failure”. Read for density: restore a verb if the sentence becomes abstract or unclear.

A5

implementation

Use “implementation”. Identify the process or quality you want to treat as a concept.

A6

by

Use “by”. Choose the correct noun form and its preposition or complement.

Two connected decisions

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

analysis / identification

Use “analysis”. Identify the process or quality you want to treat as a concept. Use “identification”. Choose the correct noun form and its preposition or complement.

B2

decision / rejection

Use “decision”. Choose the correct noun form and its preposition or complement. Use “rejection”. Decide whether the agent should remain visible.

B3

increase / expansion

Use “increase”. Decide whether the agent should remain visible. Use “expansion”. Read for density: restore a verb if the sentence becomes abstract or unclear.

Guided text

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

decision

Use “decision”. Identify the process or quality you want to treat as a concept.

C2

analysis

Use “analysis”. Choose the correct noun form and its preposition or complement.

C3

availability

Use “availability”. Decide whether the agent should remain visible.

C4

absence

Use “absence”. Read for density: restore a verb if the sentence becomes abstract or unclear.

C5

approval

Use “approval”. Identify the process or quality you want to treat as a concept.

Open text

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

decision to delay

Use “decision to delay”. Identify the process or quality you want to treat as a concept.

D2

investigation of the incident

Use “investigation of the incident”. Choose the correct noun form and its preposition or complement.

D3

lack of availability of funds

Use “lack of availability of funds”. Decide whether the agent should remain visible.

D4

failure to deliver

Use “failure to deliver”. Read for density: restore a verb if the sentence becomes abstract or unclear.

D5

response from users

Use “response from users”. Identify the process or quality you want to treat as a concept.

Controlled production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The company’s rapid expansion...

Use “The company’s rapid expansion...”. Identify the process or quality you want to treat as a concept.

E2

The approval of the plan by the agency...

Use “The approval of the plan by the agency...”. Choose the correct noun form and its preposition or complement.

E3

The team revised and implemented the procedure.

Use “The team revised and implemented the procedure.”. Decide whether the agent should remain visible.

E4

the analysis of the data

Use “the analysis of the data”. Read for density: restore a verb if the sentence becomes abstract or unclear.

Communicative mission

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The rapid expansion of the service created pressure. The service expanded rapidly, so demand increased.

The model combines accurate Nominalisation with a clear purpose. Identify the process or quality you want to treat as a concept.

F2

The cancellation of the contract by the supplier caused significant losses.

The model combines accurate Nominalisation with a clear purpose. Choose the correct noun form and its preposition or complement.

F3

Instead of the completion of the evaluation of the system, write: We evaluated the system and completed the review.

The model combines accurate Nominalisation with a clear purpose. Decide whether the agent should remain visible.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____